

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)
Top Class Education Scheme for SC Students

1. What is the objective of the Scheme?

Answer: The Scheme aims to promote quality education among Scheduled Caste (SC) students by providing financial support for pursuing studies beyond Class XII in notified institutions.

2. Who is eligible?

Answer: SC students with annual family income up to Rs.8.00 lakh, admitted in a full-time prescribed course in a notified institution, subject to the allotted slots.

3. Who can apply for Fresh Scholarship?

Answer: Only first-year students admitted during the current academic year are eligible for Fresh Scholarship.

4. Can second/third/fourth year students apply as Fresh?

Answer: No. Fresh Scholarship is available only to first-year students.

5. Which institutions are covered?

Answer: The Scheme covers notified institutions including IITs, NITs, IIITs, IIMs, AIIMS, NLUs, IHMs, NIFTs, NIDs, Central Government Institutions and other notified institutions empanelled by the Ministry.

6. How are scholarships allotted?

Answer: Scholarships are awarded strictly on inter-se merit based on the admission criteria prescribed for the course, subject to the number of slots allotted to the institution.

7. What if eligible students exceed available slots?

Answer: Scholarship is restricted to students within the allotted slots. In case of a tie for the last slot, preference is given to the student having lower

family income. Remaining eligible students may apply under the Post-Matric Scholarship Scheme, if eligible.

8. Is there reservation for girl students?

Answer: Yes. Thirty percent of allotted slots are reserved for eligible SC girl students. Unutilised reserved slots may be transferred to eligible boys as per merit.

9. What documents are required?

Answer: Valid SC Certificate, Income Certificate, Aadhaar, Aadhaar-seeded bank account details, admission details, admission rank and fee details as prescribed on NSP.

10. What are the income certificate requirements?

Answer: Self-employed parents: certificate by Revenue Officer not below Tehsildar. Salaried parents: employer certificate and Revenue Officer certificate for other income.

11. What financial assistance is provided?

Answer: Full tuition fee and non-refundable charges (up to Rs.2 lakh per annum in private institutions), Academic Allowance of Rs.86,000 in first year and Rs.41,000 per year thereafter.

12. How is scholarship released?

Answer: Scholarship is released through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) directly into the Aadhaar-seeded bank account of the student.

13. Is Aadhaar seeding mandatory?

Answer: Yes. Aadhaar-seeded bank account is mandatory for DBT.

14. How can students apply?

Answer: Students must submit applications online through the National Scholarship Portal (NSP).

15. What is the role of the institute?

Answer: Institutes verify applications, ensure slot limits, verify documents and forward eligible applications on NSP within prescribed timelines.

16. What is the last date for institute verification?

Answer: 31 October every year or any other date notified by DBT Mission.

17. Can more than two siblings receive scholarship?

Answer: No. Benefits are restricted to two siblings. An affidavit is required.

18. Can a student receive another scholarship?

Answer: No. A beneficiary cannot simultaneously avail similar scholarship from Central/State Government.

19. What happens if a student fails?

Answer: Scholarship is withheld until promotion. Once promoted, scholarship is restored automatically.

20. What happens if a student changes institute?

Answer: Scholarship under this Scheme is discontinued.

21. What happens if incorrect information is furnished?

Answer: Scholarship may be cancelled and recovery/action may be initiated as per rules.

22. Can an institute be removed from the Scheme?

Answer: Yes. Institutions may be de-notified for violation of Scheme provisions, non-participation for three consecutive years, absence of AISHE code or NSP KYC, or other reasons as per guidelines.

23. Will existing beneficiaries continue if an institute is de-notified?

Answer: Yes. Existing eligible beneficiaries continue till completion of the course. No fresh slots are allotted thereafter.

24. Where can students seek help?

Answer: Students should first contact the Institute Nodal Officer. NSP-related technical issues may also be taken up through NSP Helpdesk.

25. Where are Scheme Guidelines available?

Answer: Latest Scheme Guidelines are available on the Department's website and National Scholarship Portal (NSP).